🌐 Marketplace Feature — Full Specification

Developer-Ready Functional Spec (Markdown)

Scope: Discovery Feed, Salon Profiles, Booking Entry Points, Rules, No-Commission Model, Anti-Fresha Principles

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1. Overview

The **Marketplace** is a **client-facing discovery layer** that:

- Helps clients **discover salons** based on style, location, and preferences
- Helps salons **showcase their work** and **attract new clients**
- Integrates seamlessly with the **booking and payments** system
- Explicitly **does not steal clients**, **does not charge commission**, and **does not promote competitors** against a salon's own clients

Core principles:

1. **No client theft** — clients discovered via marketplace become the salon's clients, not the platform's.
2. **No commission** — no per-booking marketplace fee.
3. **No competitor injection** — no "similar salons near you" on a salon's own booking flow.
4. **Salon-first branding** — marketplace amplifies the salon's brand, not the platform's.

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2. Core Concepts

2.1 Entities

- **Client (End User)**
  A person browsing the marketplace and booking services.

- **Salon**
  A business using the platform; can opt into marketplace visibility.

- **Marketplace Profile**
  Public-facing salon page with:

  - Name, logo, photos, videos
  - Services (high-level view)
  - Location, hours
  - Social-style feed (posts, before/after, reels)
  - Reviews & rating
  - "Book" button

- **Post**
  Content item created by salon:

    - Photo, video, carousel
    - Caption, tags, services linked
    - Optional “Book this look” link

- **Feed**
  TikTok/Instagram-style scrollable feed of posts from salons.

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3. Salon-Side Marketplace Controls

3.1 Marketplace Opt-In

Salons can:

- **Enable/disable marketplace visibility**
- Choose:
    - Show full profile
    - Show only posts (no direct search listing)
    - Hide from search but allow direct profile link

Default: **Opted in**, but can be turned off.

3.2 Profile Management

Salon can manage:

- **Basic info**: name, logo, cover image, bio, location, hours
- **Branding**: colors, style tags (e.g., “minimalist”, “bold”, “natural”)
- **Service highlights**: featured services (e.g., “Russian volume lashes”, “Balayage”, “Gel extensions”)
- **Media**: photos, videos, before/after
- **Links**: Instagram, TikTok, website

3.3 Post Creation

Salon can create posts:

- Upload media (image/video)
- Add caption
- Tag:
    - Services
    - Style tags (e.g., “blonde”, “nail art”, “acne facial”)
    - Price range (optional)
- Mark as:
    - “Transformation”
    - “New set”
    - “Maintenance”
- Attach “Book this look” → pre-fills booking with relevant service(s)

3.4 Visibility Settings

Per salon:

- Show in:
  - Local search
  - Global search (optional)
  - Feed only
- Hide:
  - Prices (optional)
  - Staff list (optional)

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4. Client-Side Marketplace Experience

4.1 Entry Points

Clients can enter the marketplace via:

- Home screen “Discover” tab
- Search bar (location, service, style)
- Shared salon profile link
- Shared post link
- “Explore similar looks” (but **not** similar salons on booking page)

4.2 Discovery Modes

1. **Feed Mode** (default)
   - Infinite scroll of posts
   - Personalized by:
     - Location
     - Services viewed
     - Posts liked/saved
     - Bookings history
2. **Search Mode**
   - Filters:
     - Location (city, radius)
     - Service type (hair, nails, lashes, brows, massage, facials, etc.)
     - Price range
     - Rating
     - Availability (e.g., “this week”)
     - Style tags (e.g., “natural nails”, “bold color”, “curly hair”)
3. **Map Mode** (optional phase)
   - Map with salon pins
   - Tap to open profile

4.3 Salon Profile (Client View)

Profile shows:

- Name, logo, cover image
- Rating + review count
- Location + distance
- “Book” button
- “Message” button (if chat enabled)
- Services (high-level list with “from” prices)
- Gallery (grid of posts)
- About section
- Staff (optional)
- Policies (cancellation, deposits, etc.)

4.4 Post View (Client)

When client taps a post:

- Full-screen media
- Caption
- Tags (services, styles)
- “Book this look” button
- “View salon profile” button
- “Save” / “Like”

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5. Booking from Marketplace

5.1 Booking Entry Points

Client can start booking from:

- Salon profile “Book” button
- Post “Book this look” button
- Service list on profile

5.2 Booking Flow (from Marketplace)

1. Client taps “Book” or “Book this look”
2. System:
    - Pre-selects salon
    - Optionally pre-selects service (if from post)
3. Client selects:
    - Service (if not pre-selected)
    - Staff (optional)
    - Date/time
4. Payment flow:
    - Deposit or full payment (per salon rules)
5. Booking confirmation

Important rule:
Once client is in a salon’s booking flow, **no other salons are shown or suggested**.

No:

- “Similar salons near you”
- “Other options”
- “Cheaper alternatives”

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6. Rules to Avoid “Client Theft”

These rules are critical to your positioning.

6.1 No Cross-Promotion on Booking Flow

- When viewing a specific salon’s profile or booking flow:
  - Do **not** show other salons
  - Do **not** show “similar salons”
  - Do **not** show “people also booked”

6.2 Client Ownership

- Any client who books a salon via marketplace:
  - Is considered that salon’s client
  - Can be contacted by that salon directly (within platform)
  - Is not “reassigned” or “shared” with other salons

6.3 No Commission

- Marketplace does **not** charge:
  - Per-booking fee
  - “New client” fee
  - Percentage of revenue

Monetization comes from:

- Subscription
- Add-ons
- (Optionally later) paid promotion slots clearly labeled as ads

6.4 Data Transparency

- Salon can see:
  - How many new clients came from marketplace
  - Which posts generated bookings
  - Which tags/styles perform best

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7. Salon-Side Analytics

7.1 Marketplace Analytics

Salon dashboard shows:

- Profile views
- Post views
- Post likes/saves
- Clicks on “Book”
- Bookings from marketplace
- Revenue from marketplace-sourced clients

7.2 Content Performance

Per post:

- Views
- Likes
- Saves
- Bookings attributed
- Services booked from that post

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8. Client-Side Personalization

8.1 Signals Used

Personalization can use:

- Location
- Services viewed
- Posts liked/saved
- Salons followed (optional future feature)
- Past bookings
- Style tags interacted with

8.2 Feed Ranking

Basic rules:

- Prioritize:
  - Local salons
  - High-engagement posts
  - Styles client has interacted with
- Avoid:
  - Repeating same salon too often
  - Showing irrelevant services

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9. Edge Cases & States

9.1 Salon Disables Marketplace

If salon turns off marketplace:

- Profile is hidden from:

    - Search
    - Feed
    - Map
- Existing direct links:
    - Show “This salon is not publicly visible”
    - Still allow existing clients to book via direct booking link (non-marketplace)

9.2 Salon Suspended / Inactive

If salon is suspended or inactive:

- Profile hidden
- Posts hidden
- Booking disabled
- Existing bookings remain visible to clients but cannot create new ones

9.3 Client Without Account

- Browsing marketplace:
    - Allowed without login
- Booking:
    - Requires email + phone (guest) or account

9.4 Region Restrictions

- Marketplace can be:
    - Global
    - Region-limited (e.g., only certain countries)

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10. Non-Functional Requirements

- Mobile-first design
- Fast loading (lazy-load media)
- Infinite scroll feed
- Clear separation between:
    - Marketplace browsing
    - Salon booking flow
- No dark patterns (no hidden fees, no surprise redirects)

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11. Positioning Summary (for Product & UX)

The marketplace must feel like:

- **TikTok for beauty services** (inspiration + discovery)
- **Instagram profiles with booking built-in**
- **Zero-commission, salon-friendly, non-predatory**
- A place where **salons are the heroes**, not the platform

Key UX messages:

- “Discover salons by style, not just by location.”
- “Book the exact look you fall in love with.”
- “No commissions. No client stealing. Ever.”

✅ Marketplace Feature Spec Complete

If you want, next I can:

- Turn this into **user stories**
- Draft **product copy** for the marketplace screens
- Or create a **combined spec** showing how Marketplace + Payments interact end-to-end.